

SECTION:	Sustainability
SUBJECT:	Workplace Waste Management & Recycling Guide

I. Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to provide employees with guidance on proper waste disposal and recycling practices and to support the implementation of Acumetis' Waste and Recycling Policy.

II. Scope

This SOP applies to all Acumetis employees, contractors, and office locations worldwide.

III. Responsibilities

Employees

Employees are responsible for:

- Reducing the consumption of single-use items, such as paper, plastic, and disposable packaging or food products where feasible.
- Reusing materials and office supplies whenever practical before disposal or recycling.
- Properly sorting waste, recycling, and other designated waste streams in accordance with local regulations and posted office signage.
- Reviewing and complying with the Acumetis Waste and Recycling Policy and Guide.
- Using reusable kitchenware, water bottles, and other reusable items where available.
- Ensuring recyclable materials are reasonably free of food waste or contamination.
- Reporting waste management concerns to their office manager.

Office Managers

Office managers are responsible for:

- Maintaining waste and recycling signage.
- Supporting the implementation of this SOP.
- Reporting waste management concerns to the Sustainability team.

Sustainability Team

The Sustainability team is responsible for:

- Maintaining this SOP.
- Reviewing global waste management practices.
- Monitoring progress against waste and recycling targets.



IV. Office-Specific Requirements

To support consistent and responsible waste management across our global operations, employees should refer to the office-specific requirements below, as waste and recycling regulations may vary by location.

Yardley, Pennsylvania

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, glass bottles and jars, metal cans, and accepted plastic containers

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Tin, aluminum, and steel cans
- ✓ #1 and #5 plastics only
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Magazines and newspaper
- ✓ Foam packaging
- ✓ Cardboard boxes
- ✓ Cardboard rolls
- ✓ Office paper and mail

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse all containers
- Flatten cardboard boxes
- Leave recyclables loose and unbagged
- Check plastic containers for #1 or #5 recycling symbol

For more information on identifying the types of plastic that can be recycled, please refer to this tool.

Prohibited Materials

- X Styrofoam
- X Plastic bags
- X Soiled paper products
- X Aluminum foil
- X Plastic packaging and film
- X Food waste

Don't know if something can be recycled? Visit the [Bucks County Recycling Guide](#) to look up the proper disposal instructions for your item.

Source: <https://www.lmt.org/information/waste-recycling-information/>



Raleigh, North Carolina

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, plastic containers, metal cans, glass bottles and jars

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Metal cans
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Mail and office paper
- ✓ Magazines and catalogs
- ✓ Plastic jugs and bottles
- ✓ Plastic jars and tubs
- ✓ Cardboard boxes
- ✓ Cardboard rolls and cartons

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse all containers
- Flatten cardboard boxes
- Keep metal cans intact (do not crush)
- Tuck metal can lids safely inside the can
- Leave plastic bottle caps on

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Shredded paper
- ✗ Plastic bags
- ✗ Disposable plates
- ✗ Plastic utensils
- ✗ Food wrappers and plastic film
- ✗ Styrofoam
- ✗ Napkins and paper towels

Don't know if something can be recycled? Visit the [Waste Wizard](#) to look up the proper disposal instructions for your item.

Source: <https://www.carync.gov/services-publications/garbage-recycling-yard-waste/recycling/business-recycling>



San Francisco, California

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled or composted
 Recycling	Clean paper, cardboard, plastic containers, metal containers, and glass bottles and jars
 Food Waste	Food scraps, food-soiled paper, plants, and certified compostable products

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Aluminum cans, foil, and trays
- ✓ Steel and tin cans
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Paper bags
- ✓ Cardboard boxes and paperboard
- ✓ Clean coffee cups and ice cream containers
- ✓ Plastic bottles, tubs, containers, and lids
- ✓ Plastic cups, plates, and utensils
- ✓ Office paper and mail
- ✓ Newspapers, magazines, and envelopes
- ✓ Beverage cartons and juice boxes

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse all containers
- Flatten cardboard boxes
- Leave bottle caps on plastic containers
- Keep recyclables loose and unbagged
- Place shredded paper in a sealed bag labeled “Shredded Paper”

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Batteries and light bulbs
- ✗ Electronics
- ✗ Mirrors and window glass
- ✗ Ceramic dishware and glassware
- ✗ Plastic bags, wrappers, and film
- ✗ Soiled paper products
- ✗ Clothing and textiles
- ✗ Food scraps
- ✗ Styrofoam
- ✗ Waxed cardboard
- ✗ Compostable or biodegradable plastics

Compost

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Coffee grounds, filters, and tea bags
- ✓ Fruits and vegetables
- ✓ Bread, grains, rice, and pasta
- ✓ Eggshells
- ✓ Meat, bones, fish, and shellfish
- ✓ Greasy pizza boxes
- ✓ Paper napkins, towels, plates
- ✓ Paper take-out containers
- ✓ Flowers and plant trimmings
- ✓ Waxed cardboard



✓ Leftovers and spoiled food

✓ Certified compostable cups, plates, bowls,
and utensils

Prohibited Materials

✗ Plastic bags, wrappers, and film

✗ Glass, metal, and plastic items

✗ Liquids

✗ Recyclable paper and cardboard

✗ Styrofoam

✗ Plastic corks

✗ Biodegradable products not labeled
compostable

Source: <https://www.recology.com/recology-san-francisco/your-three-carts/>



Toronto, Ontario

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, glass, plastic containers, plastic bags, metal containers, and foam packaging

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Plastic bottles and containers
- ✓ Plastic shopping, sandwiches, and produce bags
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Aluminum and steel cans and tins
- ✓ Aluminum foil and trays
- ✓ Aerosol cans (empty)
- ✓ Cardboard boxes
- ✓ Newspapers, magazines, mail, and office paper
- ✓ Cereal and tissue boxes
- ✓ Beverage cartons and paper cups
- ✓ Foam cups, plates, and takeout containers
- ✓ Foam packaging from shipping materials

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse containers
- Replace caps and lids after rinsing
- Flatten all cardboard boxes
- Keep recyclables loose and unbagged
- Place shredded paper in a clear plastic bag
- Remove plastic overwraps from newspapers, magazines, and beverage cases

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Compostable or biodegradable plastics
- ✗ Clothing, shoes, and textiles
- ✗ Electronics and small appliances
- ✗ Wood products
- ✗ Batteries and light bulbs
- ✗ Scrap metal, tools, and auto parts
- ✗ Tissues, napkins, and paper towels
- ✗ Drinking glasses, dishes, ceramics, and mirrors

Don't know if something can be recycled? Visit the [Waste Wizard](https://www.toronto.ca/services-payments/recycling-organics-garbage/houses/changes-to-recycling-program/) to look up the proper disposal instructions for your item.

Source: <https://www.toronto.ca/services-payments/recycling-organics-garbage/houses/changes-to-recycling-program/>



Buenos Aires, Argentina

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, plastic containers, glass bottles and jars, metal cans, and clean packaging materials

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Office paper, mail, and envelopes
- ✓ Newspapers and magazines
- ✓ Cardboard boxes
- ✓ Plastic bottles and containers
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Aluminum cans
- ✓ Clean packaging materials

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse all containers
- Flatted cardboard boxes before disposal
- Remove food residue from recyclable items
- Keep recyclables clean and dry

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Food waste
- ✗ Electronics
- ✗ non-recyclable plastics
- ✗ Contaminated paper or cardboard
- ✗ Batteries
- ✗ General waste

Source: <https://www.mibsas.com/en/how-to-separate-waste-correctly/>



London, United Kingdom

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Waste that cannot be recycled or composted
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, plastic containers, glass, cartons, and metal packaging
 Food Waste	Food scraps and organic waste

Recycling

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Unshredded paper and cardboard
- ✓ Plastic bottles
- ✓ Cartons and Tetra Paks
- ✓ Food tins and cans
- ✓ Empty aerosol cans
- ✓ Flattened cardboard boxes
- ✓ Plastic pots, tubs, trays, and tubes
- ✓ Glass bottles and jars
- ✓ Aluminum foil

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse containers
- Flatten cardboard boxes
- Squash plastic bottles and containers
- Leave bottle lids on plastic containers
- Remove metal lids from glass jars and bottles and place them loose in the recycling bin.

Not sure if an item is recyclable? Check the packaging for recycling symbols and refer to the [Recycling Labels Guide](#) for more information.

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Food and garden waste
- ✗ Batteries and light bulbs
- ✗ Electrical items
- ✗ Plastic wrappers and film
- ✗ Polystyrene
- ✗ Shredded paper
- ✗ Clothing, shoes, and textiles
- ✗ Plastic bags and bin liners
- ✗ Food-soiled packaging
- ✗ Paper towels

Compost (Brown Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Fruit and vegetable peelings
- ✓ Tea bags



- ✓ Coffee grounds and filters
- ✓ Leftover food scraps

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Paper towels
- ✗ Plastic film
- ✗ Coffee cups
- ✗ Liquids
- ✗ Plastic packaging

Sources: <https://londonrecycles.co.uk/business/>, <https://www.lbhf.gov.uk/recycling-and-rubbish/recycling-home/what-can-and-cant-be-recycled>



Paris, France

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Trash	Non-recyclable waste that cannot be sorted into another stream
 Recycling	Paper, cardboard, metal, plastic, and plastic packaging
 Glass	Glass bottles, jars, and containers
 Food Waste	Food scraps and compostable organic waste

Recycling (Yellow Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Paper and envelopes
- ✓ Books and magazines
- ✓ Flattened cardboard boxes
- ✓ Pizza boxes and food-soiled cardboard (no food scraps)
- ✓ Plastic bottles and containers
- ✓ Metal cans and tins
- ✓ Aerosol cans (empty)
- ✓ Aluminum foil and trays
- ✓ Coffee capsules
- ✓ Bottle caps and jar lids

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Food waste
- ✗ Glass bottles or jars
- ✗ General trash

Glass (White Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Glass bottles
- ✓ Glass jars
- ✓ Glass food containers

Prohibited Materials:

- ✗ Ceramics
- ✗ Mirrors
- ✗ Drinking glasses
- ✗ General waste

Compost (Brown Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Fruit and vegetable scraps
- ✓ Meat and fish scraps
- ✓ Pasta, rice, and potatoes
- ✓ Eggshells
- ✓ Bread and pastries
- ✓ Cheese and dairy products



- ✓ Tea bags
- ✓ Paper napkins
- ✓ Shellfish shells (oysters, mussels, etc.)

- ✓ Coffee filters and grounds
- ✓ Expired food (remove packaging first)

Important Notes:

- Place food waste loose or in a compostable/kraft paper bag
- Remove all packaging before disposal

Source: <https://www.paris.fr/en/pages/what-to-do-with-your-waste-32813>



Hamburg, Germany

Sorting Streams at a Glance

Bin	What Goes In
 Residual Waste	Non-recyclable waste that cannot be sorted into another stream
 Recycling	Plastic, metal, and composite packaging
 Paper and Cardboard	Paper products and cardboard
 Food Waste	Food scraps and compostable organic waste
 Glass	Glass bottles and jars

Recycling (Yellow Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Plastic bottles and containers
- ✓ Plastic bags, film, and packaging
- ✓ Metal cans, lids, and caps
- ✓ Aluminum foil and trays
- ✓ Milk and juice cartons
- ✓ multi-material food packaging
- ✓ Empty aerosol cans

Before you Recycle:

- Empty and rinse containers
- Remove lids from containers
- Place items loose in the bin
- Do not nest containers inside one another

Prohibited Materials

- X Glass
- X Batteries
- X Textiles
- X Paper and cardboard
- X Electronics
- X Hazardous materials

Paper and Cardboard (Blue Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Office paper and mail
- ✓ Paper bags
- ✓ Newspapers and magazines
- ✓ Cardboard boxes and cartons

Prohibited Materials:

- X Greasy pizza boxes
- X Food-soiled paper
- X Waxed paper
- X Beverage cartons (place in Yellow Bin)



Remember to flatten cardboard boxes before disposal.

Compost (Brown Bin)

Accepted Materials:

- | | |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ✓ Fruit and vegetable scraps | ✓ Coffee grounds and tea leaves |
| ✓ Eggshells | ✓ Leaves and small garden waste |
| | ✓ Bread and food scraps |

Prohibited Materials

- | | |
|---|-----------------------|
| ✗ Plastic bags (including compostable bags) | ✗ Packaging materials |
| ✗ Liquids | ✗ non-organic waste |

Glass

Accepted Materials:

- ✓ Glass bottles
- ✓ Glass food jars
- ✓ Glass cosmetic containers

Prohibited Materials:

- | | |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| ✗ Drinking glasses | ✗ Ceramics and pottery |
| ✗ Mirrors and window glass | ✗ Light bulbs |

Remove lids and caps from glass containers before disposal and place them in the yellow recycling bin.

Source: <https://handbookgermany.de/en/waste-separation>



Visakhapatnam, India

Accepted Waste Streams

- Trash
- Recycling
- Compost
- Electronics

